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SOC EXERCISE // STUDENT SUBMISSION

Security Incident Ticket

Complete all sections based on your alert analysis. Expand each section by clicking the header. When finished, use the Submit button to prepare your D2L submission.

10 of 10 required fields completed 100%

01 Ticket Metadata

STUDENT NAME *

John Tuttle

DATE SUBMITTED *

04 / 12 / 2026

ALERT ID *

EXA-2024-0102

ALERT SEVERITY *

Critical

ALERT TITLE *

Insider Data Exfiltration via Cloud Storage

ANALYST NAME

John Tuttle

TICKET STATUS

Open

02 Alert Summary

ALERT DESCRIPTION *

rocclins on internal host 10.4.6.55 accessed a large volume of sensitive files, compressed them into a 2.1GB archive, and transmitted the data externally to mega.nz over HTTPS. The user also copied files to a USB device and accesseda secure server room after hours.

INITIAL ASSESSMENT *

Malicious activity

FALSE POSITIVE ANALYSIS

Unlikely, use of personal cloud storage and after hours activity indicates malicious activity.

03 Affected Systems & Users

INTERNAL HOST / IP #1	INTERNAL HOST / IP #2	INTERNAL HOST / IP #3
10.4.6.55	*e.g. 10.0.8.5*	*e.g. 10.0.1.5 (DC)*

USERNAME(S) INVOLVED	EXTERNAL / ATTACKER IP(S)	PORTS / PROTOCOLS
rcollins	66.203.125.10	443/HTTPS, DNS

SYSTEMS AT RISK

HR records, Finance data, Legal Contracts

04 Event Timeline

Reconstruct events in chronological order from the correlated log entries.

#	TIMESTAMP	HOST / SOURCE	DESCRIPTION OF ACTIVITY
1	2024-11-12 13:10:0	10.4.6.55	User rcollins accessed ~880 sensitive files across HR, Finance, an
2	2024-11-12 13:14:3	10.4.6.55	7zip process executed to compress collected files into archive
3	2024-11-12 13:22:1	10.4.6.55	Archive file created in local temp directory
4	2024-11-12 13:30:4	10.4.6.55	DNS query made to external domain mega.nz
5	2024-11-12 13:31:0	10.4.6.55	Large HTTPS POST upload sent to external IP 66.203.125.10
6	2024-11-12 14:10:0	10.4.6.55	USB storage device connected to system
7	2024-11-12 14:11:4	10.4.6.55	~880 files copied from staging directory to USB drive
8	2024-11-12 14:44:1	Badge Reader/Physical	User accessed server room after hours

+ Add Event

05 Indicators of Compromise (IOCs)

IOC TYPE	VALUE	WHERE OBSERVED	NOTES
IP Address	66.203.125.10	HTTO POST/DNS logs	external IP associated with n
Domain / URL	mega.nz	DNS query logs	cloud storage service used fc

IOC TYPE	VALUE	WHERE OBSERVED	NOTES
File Name	arch.zip	file creation logs	2.1gb archive containing sen
File Hash (MD5/SHA)	*Enter value*	*Log source / event*	*Additional context*
Username	rcollins	multiple logs (DLP, process, l	primary user preforming all s
Process Name	7z.exe	process creation logs	used to compress files prior t

+ Add IOC

06 MITRE ATT&CK Mapping

Map observed behaviors to MITRE ATT&CK. Reference attack.mitre.org as needed.

TACTIC	TECHNIQUE ID	TECHNIQUE NAME	LOG EVIDENCE	CONFIDENCE
Collection	*T1566.001*	*Technique name*	*Supporting log evidence*	Select...
Exfiltration	*T1566.001*	*Technique name*	*Supporting log evidence*	Select...
Select tactic...	*T1566.001*	*Technique name*	*Supporting log evidence*	Select...

+ Add Technique

07 Full Incident Analysis

WHAT HAPPENED? *

On November 12, 2024 user rcollins on host 10.4.6.55 accessed approximately 880 sensitive files across HR, Finance, and Legal directories triggering a DLP alert. Shortly after, the user executed 7z.exe to compress data into a 2.1gb archive file located in a local temp directory.
The system then preformed a DNS query to mega.nz, followed by a large HTTPS POST upload to external IP 66.203.125.10, indicating potential data exfil via cloud storage.

ATTACK VECTOR / ENTRY POINT

legitimate user account rcollins, indicates insider threat scenario

ATTACKER OBJECTIVES

data exfiltration

SCOPE OF IMPACT

incident appears to be limited to a single host and a single user account. however, data impacted spans multiple sensitive departments.

CONFIDENCE LEVEL & REASONING

high confidence level. multiple correlated log sources, and combination of bulk sensitive data access, compression and exfil provides strong evidence of malicious activity.

08 Escalation Decision

Escalate to Customer? YES NO

RECOMMENDED SEVERITY

Critical

JUSTIFICATION *

data exfil of sensitive data

RECOMMENDED IMMEDIATE ACTIONS

disable account (rcollins)
isolate host 10.4.6.55 from network
block outbound connections to mega.nz and IP 66.203.125.10

CUSTOMER NOTIFICATION SUMMARY

We detected that a user accessed and copied a large number of sensitive files, then transferred the data outside the organization using both cloud storage and a USB device.

09 Containment & Recommendations

SHORT-TERM CONTAINMENT *

diable compromised user account
isolate affected endpoint
block external communication to associated IPs and domains

ERADICATION STEPS

preform full forensic analysis of host
remove any unauthorized tools or files(arch.zip)
reimage system if compromise cannot be ruled out

RECOVERY STEPS

restore system to known good state
re-enable access only after validation and monitoring

LESSONS LEARNED / GAPS IDENTIFIED

insufficient least privilege access controls, data loss prevention controls were not enforced or not configured correctly, gaps in behavioral monitoring.